

Role Of Communication Skills in Educational Counselling and Student Guidance

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Abstract

The exponential rise of EdTech platforms and private educational institutions, effective counseling is becoming quintessential as students are bombarded with significantly high number of academic options. They are the first point of contact with prospective and new students, helping them in identifying suitable educational programs. A well-rounded understanding of the above is best exemplified in communication skills such as active listening, clarity in explanation, empathy and feedback (constructive). This study has collected primary data by using structured questionnaires distributed to 60th students as well as admission counselors. Results showed that effective communication skills are an important factor in developing rapport with students during the counseling process which enhances student trust, satisfaction and confidence. The study highlighted that institutions must develop counselors' communication competencies effectively to provide effective educational counseling. This research investigates the significance of communication skills in education-based counseling and their impact on students' decision-making processes and levels of involvement.

Keywords— Communication Skills, Educational Counseling, EdTech Platforms, Student Engagement.

I. Introduction

The education industry is evolving fast with the rise of numerous EdTech firms, online education platforms, private schools, and other academic courses. Students are presented with plenty of course and professional choices, thus getting into confusion while choosing the career option. This is where educational counseling comes into play in assisting learners to opt for appropriate academic and professional directions.

Educational counseling enables learners to comprehend various aspects like course information, admission process, career possibilities, and institutional rules.

Good communication skills are vital for efficient counseling and can improve motivation level for clear goal setting along with academic performance. Educators should effectively convey their thoughts, actively listen to students' views, and reply professionally and compassionately. Effective communication fosters trust, enhances learner

engagement, and facilitates informed decisions; ineffective communication leads to miscommunication and dissatisfaction.

II. Literature Review

Some studies have investigated the significance of communication in counseling and the development of students. Ibrahim [1] applied the review methodology to point out the multiple components of communication. Namely, communication involves such components as empathy, active listening, and even verbal and nonverbal parts of communication. The findings of the study have shown that empathy is important for solving students' emotional issues, and communication itself facilitates reflection, decision-making, and problem-solving processes. Chenyu, Krishnasamy, and Rui [2] used an exploratory approach to analyze the development of communication skills. Self-reflection and experiential learning were proved to be crucial for improving communication abilities. In turn, self-assessment played a significant role in this process. The application of simulation-based learning in Kanji and Watermeyer's [3] study allowed the researchers to conclude about its positive influence on communication ability improvement.

The results of another quantitative study carried out by Guo, Asmawi, and Fan [4] have showed that emotional intelligence mediates social anxiety and communication skills in the case of middle school students. The authors of an article written by Widyarto, Rahmawati, and Ramli [5] investigated the effect of group counseling and found that sharing experiences and reflective conversation increased the level of self-confidence and reduced communication anxiety.

Fauzi and Yustiana [6] used literature review to prove that guidance services could considerably improve social skills of children as a result of the participation of school counselors. Additionally, Pahlevi and Riksa [7] studied the acquisition of counseling skills in university students.

Using a cross-sectional survey in nursing education, Wang et al. [8] have found that a favorable learning environment was related to metacognitive development. Meanwhile, interpersonal communication contributed to the growth of professional skills. According to the results of the empirical study by Holman et al. [9], collaboration and performing academic activities contributed to the improvement of team skills, communication ability, confidence, and career readiness of graduate students. Finally, Zheng, Feng, and Wang [10] proved the key role of.

trust, psychological safety, counselor competence, and effective communication techniques contributed to the counseling process. Verbal and nonverbal communication helped participants become more aware of their decisions.

Besides, Abdullah [11] used a qualitative and documentary methodology to emphasize the significance of counseling services for providing a wide range of support to students, which includes preventive, developmental, remedial, and advocacy functions. In addition, the author paid attention to the increasing need for such services as well. Alam and Akhmadi [12] found that guidance and counseling programs.

The present study and response received has clearly emphasized that effective communication skills are the core requirement for effective counselling and to ensure that it turns into meaningful sentence for students academic success.

Existing research predominantly focuses on the students' perspective rather than the counselors' viewpoint. The available sample sizes are limited and tend to provide a broad conceptual overview rather than in-depth analysis. Furthermore, there is a noticeable lack of empirical validation, and minimal attention has been given to communication practices at the elementary school level. The present study focuses on both counselor as well as students perspective for counselling. Also the responses has been collected diverse set of people.

III. Research Methodology

To collect primary data, structured questionnaires were provided to both students and educational counselors at educational institutions and EdTech platforms. The questions on the questionnaire were focused on communication, including clarity of messages, listening skills, empathy and providing feedback during educational counseling sessions.

The data was collected through structured questionnaires administered to students and educational counselors from different organizations and EdTech platforms. Most of the respondents are undergraduate students (82.4%), followed by postgraduate students (8.1%), school level respondents (5.4%), and others (4.1%). In regard to counselors, admission counselors are the most numerous (36.8%), followed by academic counselors (31.6%), whereas career counselors and others are equally represented (15.8%).

A descriptive analysis was used to analyze the data collected to determine the relationship between effective communication skills and student participation in education counseling as well as the effectiveness of educational counseling. The questionnaires was formed based on the following factors keeping in mind the prespective of both students as well as counselor:

1. Academic Qualification

2. Student's perception of counselor communication.
3. Counselor feedback effectiveness with respect to Academic guidance.
4. Impact of counselling on student motivation
5. Correlation of communication skills & Academic performance

IV. Figures And Results

A. Student Response Graphs

Students' perceptions of counselors' communication, transparency, and counseling effectiveness are presented in these graphs.

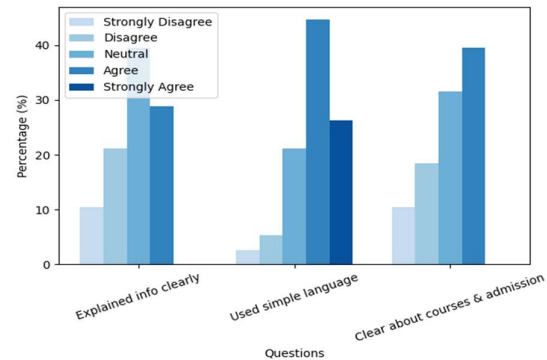


Figure 1: Students' responses on clarity and understandability of counselors' communication

Students' views on the clarity of communication by the counselors are depicted in Figure 1. It is evident that many of the respondents were in agreement and some of them strongly agreed that the counselors communicated using easy-to-understand language and made sure that the course and admission process were explained clearly. Some respondents were neutral and very few disagreed. This reveals that effective communication is one area where counseling is very good.

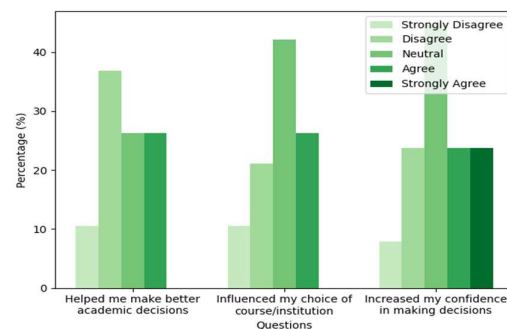


Figure 2: Students' perceptions of counseling effectiveness and counselor influence on academic decision-making

The **figure 2** shows that most respondents selected Agree and Strongly Agree, indicating that counselors provided clear, simple, and understandable information. A few responses were neutral, while very few disagreed. Overall, the results suggest that effective communication helps students better understand academic options and make informed decisions.

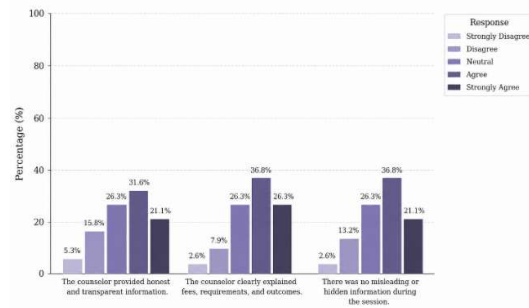


Figure 3: Students' perception of transparency and honesty in counseling sessions

Figure 3 shows the results gathered from students on the level of transparency during counseling sessions. A great number of students felt that counselors were upfront in providing them with relevant information related to the cost, criteria, and results of their counseling process. A considerable number of students also indicated their strong agreement that counselors were not withholding any information or presenting anything misleading. Only a small number of students disagreed.

Based on the feedback received from the students, it becomes clear that communication is vital in educational counseling. Most students agreed that counselors ensured that they understood all information about the courses, admission, and other academic decisions using simple language. This helps the students to remove all their queries and take proper decisions about their studies. Furthermore, most students agreed that counseling helped them build self-confidence while making decisions related to the courses, colleges, and even careers.

B. Counselor Response Graphs

The following graphs represent counselors' perceptions of issues in communication and professional development.

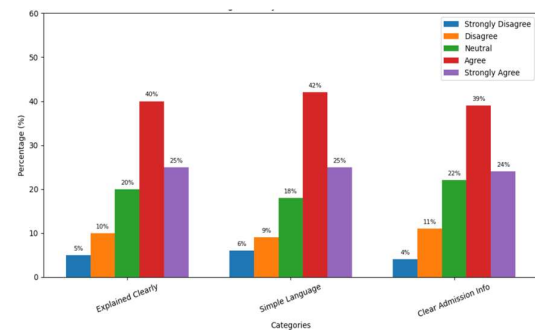


Fig. 1. Clarity of counselor communication during academic guidance sessions

Figure 1 demonstrates the responses of individuals on whether the counselors were effective in explaining the details about courses and their career paths. It is quite evident from the figure that many of the responses belong to categories 'Agree' and 'Strongly Agree.'

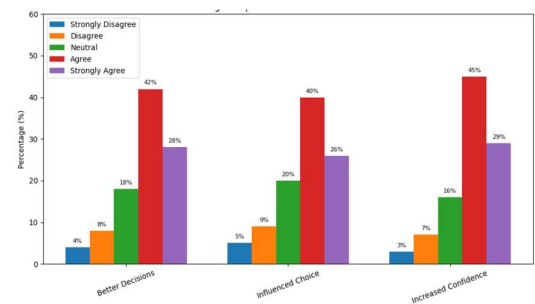


Fig. 2. Impact of counseling communication on student confidence

As illustrated in Fig. 2 below, the majority of participants hold the view that good communication by counselors positively impacts students' confidence after counseling sessions. This emphasizes the significance of communication skills in influencing student decisions.

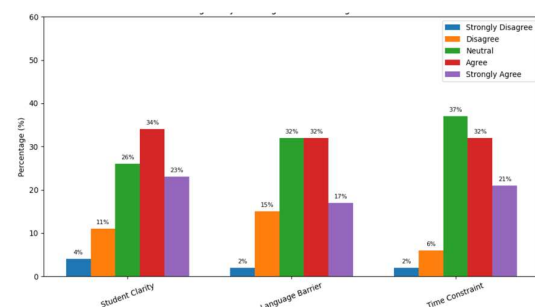


Fig. 3. Lack of student clarity as a challenge in counseling sessions

Fig. 3 shows the distribution of answers about poor student clarity as one of the communication problems. Many respondents point to this problem, indicating that there is some misunderstanding or unclear expectations on the part of students that may impede counseling.

V. Conclusion

Counselors' ability to communicate effectively – through empathetic listening, articulating ideas clearly, and interacting in an honest manner – enhances students' experiences in counseling by creating a supportive environment where they can comfortably discuss their academic and professional aspirations with their counselor. Students develop a strong relationship of trust with their counselor due to effective communication; thus developing the student's confidence in selecting academic programs. Institutions that provide extensive training for counselors on how to communicate effectively to students generate higher student satisfaction rates and greater-than-average enrollment.

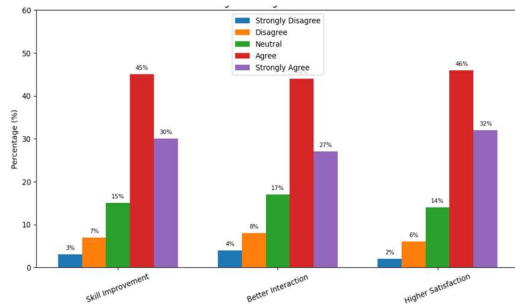


Fig. 4. Effectiveness of communication skills training for counselors

As shown in Fig. 4, it is evident that majority of the participants think that training sessions positively affect the effectiveness of counseling sessions. The high degree of agreement highlights the significance of institutional support in developing the communication skills of counselors.

Based on the counselor's responses, there is an agreement that good communication skills are required to be an effective counselor. The majority of counselors agreed that explaining things clearly and actively listening can enable the students to gain an understanding of their educational possibilities and make sound decisions. Furthermore, good communication enables the student to become confident and motivated while undergoing counseling. One of the problems that counselors encounter is that some students do not have clear objectives when seeking assistance. Training courses for developing communication skills were highly recommended as it enhances listening abilities, empathy, feedback skills, and counseling efficiency.

According to the results of the research, effective counsellors utilize a range of communication skills such as providing emotional support through listening and then, as needed, clearly explaining their position, in order to build a sense of trust between themselves and the student. This trust enables the student to have an opportunity to share information regarding their academic path and career aspirations. In addition to the trust between the student and the counsellor, effective communication has an impact on the student's level of confidence will in deciding on an academic program. Higher levels of student satisfaction and improved recruitment efforts for those institutions providing counselling training from a communication stand point are evident.

VI. References

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